BIRCH WILSON

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Spencer MA

An online presence is required in the digital age to drive engagements for the band. Even for the bands that thrive in the underground, a digital presence drives engagements with the fanbase.

BACKGROUND

Birch Wilson is a local band in my hometown in Central MA. The type of music they play is not traditional or mainstream. It is psychedelic rock or sometimes coined “doom rock”. This genre typically is viewed as more underground, and therefore does not have the benefit of being popularized by word of mouth. The target audience tends to be other musicians, or consumers with a deeper and refined taste for bands such as Elder, King Buffalo, and Slomosa. These bands could be seen as competitors or headliners for Birch Wilson to support on tour.

The band today has a Spotify with a handful of songs out today. 48% of Americans use Spotify to learn about music, nearly doubling from 25% in 2016 (Edison Research). Leveraging an existing Spotify and linking it to the digital page should direct potential consumers of the music to learn more about the band. These types of musical acts are generally “found” online through a searching algorithm for similar sounding underground rock so the Spotify algo and link should help the band gain more reach. There is limited promotion compared to these other similar bands as the client’s budget is not as significant for professional recordings nor marketing materials. What Birch Wilson is lacking is an online presence to unify the Spotify and the Instagram. Additionally the content and art is not as developed on the Instagram, therefore we need the digital presence to capture more background on the band. Typically these “doom rock” and psychedelic rock bands cater to consumers that like dark themes, galaxies, moons, and surrealism in the artwork. I have created elements for this on the website.

Birch Wilson does not interact with its audience today outside of gigs and prospective clients do not have a way to book the band. There is no contact info, no forms to sign up for notifications. This has been added on the website on Wix after seeing similar engagement forms from King Buffalo , Elder and Slomosa. Written communication is preferred by the younger generation who typically likes this type of music as the BBC survey referenced by Boston Brand Media with 70% of ages 18-31 preferring to respond on their own time (Boston Brand Media).

The online website also has a blog section, where local artists and published pieces can review and talk about the band. This helps with the communicate based nature of the band that it needs to thrive. Additionally, the band can post updates on the site for where the show are , build pressure to buy tickets, and control inventory for tickets for the show. This takes management pressure off of the band, and also takes pressure off of selling tickets elsewhere. This Wix website tool is a centralized platform for the branding of Birch Wilson, and can deliver the aesthetic,, unified art and digital music platforms in a one-stop-shop location for potential consumers to interact with the band.

URL FOR THE WEBSITE

https://lacrojc.wixsite.com/birch-wilson

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